

Infrastructure & Growth Cost Plan

A clear, staged budget for running FlowTrack on AWS — from launch (1,500 users) to scale (4,000 users) — including servers, database, storage, hosting, domain and marketing.

Prepared: July 2026 • Currency: USD • Model: Per-seat SaaS

1. Executive Summary

The product is already built. The only ongoing costs are hosting/infrastructure and marketing. Below is a two-phase plan.

NET ARPU / PAID USER \$4.00 /mo Blended across plans	GROSS MARGIN / USER \$3.30 After Stripe + infra (~82%)	BREAK-EVEN (PHASE 1) ~355 paying users
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ITEM	PHASE 1 — 1,500 USERS	PHASE 2 — 4,000 USERS
Infrastructure / month	~\$175	~\$320
Marketing / month (recommended)	\$1,000	\$2,000
Total running cost / month	~\$1,175	~\$2,320
Revenue potential (all paying × \$4)	\$6,000	\$16,000
Profit at full capacity / month	~\$4,825	~\$13,680

Bottom line: Because the software is already developed, break-even needs only a few hundred paying users. Phase 1 turns profitable at ~355 paying users; at full 1,500 users it earns ~\$4,825/month (~\$57,900/year) on a single server.

ONE-TIME SETUP COST

ITEM	COST	NOTE
Mac Mini (to build/sign the macOS app)	~\$600	\$0 if already owned
Windows license	~\$150	\$0 if already owned
Total one-time	~\$0-750	Usually already owned

2. Launch Setup — up to 1,500 Users

Single application server + managed database (AWS RDS) + object storage (S3). One server comfortably handles ~1,500 registered users ($\approx$ 200–400 concurrently active).

MONTHLY INFRASTRUCTURE

COMPONENT	WHAT IT DOES	COST / MONTH
App server (AWS EC2 t3.medium)	Runs the application	\$30
Database (AWS RDS db.t3.small)	Managed MySQL	\$28
S3 storage	Screenshots & files	\$20
EBS disk (30–50 GB)	Server storage	\$5
Data transfer	Bandwidth	\$15
Frontend hosting (Vercel/Netlify)	Web app	\$20
Email service (SES/Postmark)	Transactional email	\$15
Backup + monitoring	Safety & uptime	\$10
Domain	~\$12 / year	\$1
Licenses (Apple \$99 + Windows signing \$250 / yr)	Monthly share	\$30
Infrastructure total		~\$175

TOTAL MONTHLY COST (INFRA + MARKETING)

SCENARIO	INFRA	MARKETING	TOTAL / MONTH	BREAK-EVEN USERS
Infra only (no marketing)	\$175	\$0	~\$175	~55
Infra + light marketing	\$175	\$500	~\$675	~205
Infra + recommended marketing	\$175	\$1,000	~\$1,175	~355
Infra + aggressive marketing	\$175	\$2,000	~\$2,175	~660

PROFIT WHEN THE SERVER IS FULL (1,500 PAYING USERS)

Revenue (1,500 $\times$ \$4)	\$6,000 / mo
Infrastructure	– \$175
Marketing	– \$1,000
Monthly profit	~\$4,825

Yearly profit

~\$57,900

Two rules that keep one server fast: (1) always store screenshots in S3, not on the server disk; (2) keep the database on a separate RDS instance. These two decisions are what let a single server scale smoothly.

3. Growth Setup — up to 4,000 Users

Scale up the app server and database, add a Redis cache. This setup comfortably handles ~4,000+ users and can be extended further with a load balancer and multiple app servers.

MONTHLY INFRASTRUCTURE

COMPONENT	WHAT IT DOES	COST / MONTH
App server (AWS EC2 t3.large)	Runs the application	\$60
Database (AWS RDS db.t3.medium)	Managed MySQL	\$60
Redis cache (cache.t3.micro)	Speeds up requests	\$12
S3 storage	Screenshots & files	\$45
EBS disk	Server storage	\$8
Data transfer	Bandwidth	\$35
Frontend hosting (Vercel/Netlify)	Web app	\$20
Email service (SES/Postmark)	Transactional email	\$25
Backup + monitoring	Safety & uptime	\$20
Domain	~\$12 / year	\$1
Licenses (Apple + Windows signing)	Monthly share	\$30
Infrastructure total		~\$320

TOTAL MONTHLY COST (INFRA + MARKETING)

SCENARIO	INFRA	MARKETING	TOTAL / MONTH	BREAK-EVEN USERS
Infra only	\$320	\$0	~\$320	~100
Infra + \$1,000 marketing	\$320	\$1,000	~\$1,320	~400
Infra + recommended marketing	\$320	\$2,000	~\$2,320	~705
Infra + aggressive marketing	\$320	\$3,500	~\$3,820	~1,160

PROFIT WHEN THE SERVER IS FULL (4,000 PAYING USERS)

Revenue (4,000 × \$4)	\$16,000 / mo
Infrastructure	– \$320
Marketing	– \$2,000

Monthly profit	~\$13,680
Yearly profit	~\$164,160

Scaling note: Beyond 4,000 users, add a load balancer + a second app server (~\$120/mo extra) to reach 10,000–20,000 users. Infrastructure cost stays a small fraction of revenue at every stage.

4. Side-by-Side Summary

METRIC	PHASE 1 (1,500)	PHASE 2 (4,000)
Server	t3.medium	t3.large
Database	RDS db.t3.small	RDS db.t3.medium
Cache	—	Redis micro
Infrastructure / month	~\$175	~\$320
Marketing / month	\$1,000	\$2,000
Total cost / month	~\$1,175	~\$2,320
Break-even (paying users)	~355	~705
Revenue at full capacity	\$6,000	\$16,000
Profit / month (full)	~\$4,825	~\$13,680
Profit / year (full)	~\$57,900	~\$164,160

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Running the software is cheap: **~\$175/month** at launch, **~\$320/month** at 4,000 users.
- Only **~355 paying users** are needed to become profitable in Phase 1.
- At full capacity, a single Phase 1 server earns **~\$57,900/year**; Phase 2 earns **~\$164,160/year**.
- Infrastructure is always a tiny fraction of revenue — **marketing** is the main growth lever.
- Costs drop a further **30–50%** with AWS Reserved Instances / Savings Plans.

ASSUMPTIONS

- Blended net revenue of **\$4.00 per paid user / month** (mix of Starter \$2.49, Professional \$3.99, Enterprise \$5.99).
- Variable cost per user ~\$0.70 (Stripe + storage) → gross margin **\$3.30/user**.
- AWS on-demand prices (us-east-1), rounded; actual bills vary with usage.
- Screenshots stored in S3; database on managed RDS.